

Enrolling a UConn Participant

 Roles: Care Coordinator + Registered Dietitian  Version 0.1 (draft)  Reviewed May 2026

 **Draft** — example content pending clinical and operational review. Do not use for training or to enroll participants until approved.

This procedure takes a participant from UConn referral to enrolled and onboarded — the handoff from care coordinator to registered dietitian. The contract sets the pace: **intake happens within 7 days of the referral.**

Scope

A shared procedure across two roles. Each step names who owns it.

For	Cena care coordinators and registered dietitians enrolling participants into the UConn Health pilot.
Covers	Receiving a referral, obtaining consent, creating the participant record, completing the intake assessment within 7 days, administering the baseline assessments, and kicking off the care plan.
Does not cover	Ongoing weekly check-ins (Care Coordinator SOP) or the recurring counseling sessions (Registered Dietitian SOP). UConn owns screening and referral generation upstream.

From referral to enrolled

Work the steps in order. The first four are the care coordinator's; the last two are the dietitian's.

1 Care Coordinator — Receive and acknowledge the referral

- In [Care-coordinator app > Referrals](#) — referrals arrive from UConn's Epic via Athena.
- ✓ The referral is acknowledged and intake is started — the 7-day clock begins at referral.
- i If the electronic referral hasn't arrived, use the manual/paper referral fallback and enter it yourself.

2 Care Coordinator — Obtain IRB consent

- In Athena, using the UConn-provided consent form (see the consent paths below).
- ✓ Consent is recorded on the participant record with a timestamp, before anything else proceeds.
- i No participant takes part in the program until consent is captured. Athena is the system of record for consent.

3 Care Coordinator — Create or confirm the participant account

- In Athena; the account syncs to the Cena platform.
- ✓ A participant record exists in both systems, ready for intake data.

4 Care Coordinator — Complete the intake assessment (within 7 days)

- In the intake form on the participant record.
- ✓ Demographics, medical history, dietary assessment, and cultural food preferences are captured.
- i Some fields import from Athena or the referral; the rest come from talking with the participant.

5 Registered Dietitian — Administer the baseline assessments (Month 0)

- In the Cena assessment forms on the participant record.
- ✓ HFIAS, HEI (via 24-hour dietary recall), WHOQOL-HIV BREF, and NKQ are completed and scored.
- i These are the study's baseline — they repeat at later months, so accuracy now matters for the whole program.

6 Registered Dietitian — Build the initial care plan

- In [Cena platform > Care plan](#) .
- ✓ An individualized nutrition care plan and goals, seeded from intake and the baseline assessments. The participant is now enrolled.

How consent arrives

Consent reaches you one of three ways. Confirm which, then proceed.

 Referral path	→ Athena may already carry the consent from UConn — confirm it's on the record before proceeding.
 Non-referral path	→ Create the record in Athena and obtain consent directly from the participant.
 Paper backup	→ Consent signed on paper in clinic — enter it into Athena so the record is complete.

Quick reference

The 7-day enrollment, condensed to a tickable list.

For every new referral

- ☐ Acknowledge the referral and start the 7-day clock
- ☐ Capture IRB consent before anything else
- ☐ Create or confirm the participant account in Athena
- ☐ Complete the intake assessment within 7 days
- ☐ Administer the Month 0 baseline assessments (RD)
- ☐ Build the initial care plan (RD)

Terms used in this SOP

Plain-language definitions, no system jargon.

Referral

UConn telling us a patient is eligible and should be enrolled. It arrives electronically, or on paper as a backup.

IRB consent

The participant's agreement to take part in the study, on UConn's form. Required before anything else.

Intake assessment

The first deep data capture — who they are, their health history, what they eat, and their food preferences.

Baseline assessments

Four standard questionnaires given at Month 0 (and again later) to measure the program's effect over time.

Care plan

The participant's individual nutrition plan and goals, built from intake and the baseline assessments.

Sign-off

This procedure clears more than one gate. It is approved for use only when all are signed.



Sign-off

🕒 Clinically accurate — clinical lead (assessments + care plan)

🕒 Operationally true — Vanessa Sena

🕒 Signed off — Director of Clinical Ops

Awaiting all gates — draft, not yet approved for use

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